

ENGLISH LANGUAGE PAPER 4

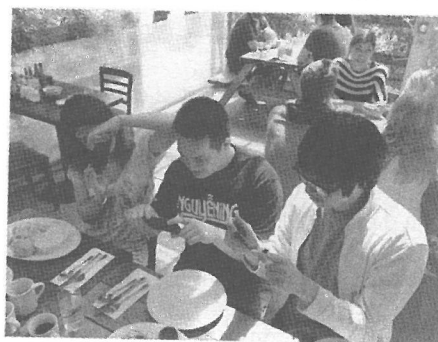
PART A Group Interaction

Below is an extract from an online article about taking photos of food:

Crazy about food photos!

Years ago, if you took out a camera to take pictures of your food, or your friend's food, people might have laughed at you. Nowadays, more and more people are taking food photos and uploading them on Facebook, Twitter or Instagram. But according to a mental health expert, Dr. Valerie Taylor, photographing food is an indication of mental illness and of health problems. She says that those who constantly take pictures of what they're eating usually have some type of unhealthy relationship between food and their weight.

"We take pictures of things that are important to us, and for some people, the food itself becomes central and the rest – the venue, the company, etc. – is background," Dr. Taylor says. Obsessing about food photography could lead to "unhealthy weight disorders".



However, others feel that taking photos of food could also suggest one's eagerness to share with others what one has eaten or the celebration of one's passion. Some also feel that a picture speaks a thousand words, and so a picture of last night's dinner might best describe an incredible meal. It is also sometimes fun to take pictures of strange foods (e.g. grasshoppers covered in chocolate), or the food you encounter when you are travelling to keep a memory of that moment.

Your group is doing a project on taking photos of food for a food blog. You may want to talk about:

- why some people love taking photos of food
- any negative effects of taking photos of food
- how to put together a blog about food photos
- anything else you think is important

PART B Individual Response

1. Do you like looking at photos of food?
2. Do your friends like taking photos of food?
3. How do you feel when your friends take photos of *your* food?
4. Have you ever scolded someone for taking photos of food?
5. Do you think taking photos of food is bad manners?
6. Should restaurants ban people from taking photos of their food?
7. How has social media enhanced people's love of food photography?
8. Can food photography be considered "works of art"?